Excel Project 1: Trip Financing and Cost Analysis

PROJECT SCOPE

This project is based on Chapters 1-3 of the OER Excel textbook. Your goal is to analyze the costs and loan options for a potential vacation using Excel skills learned in class.

BACKGROUND

Your credit union offers a "See the World" travel loan at a 1.9% annual interest rate, allowing up to $5,000 in borrowing over a maximum of 3 years. Tempted by the offer, you decide to evaluate the financial implications using Excel. Create a flexible workbook, applying best practices and Excel functionalities covered so far.

PROJECT REQUIREMENTS

Workbook Overview

Your workbook should contain three worksheets:

- **Trip Expenses** – An itemized breakdown of the estimated costs for the trip.
- **Loan Analysis** – A summary of the loan details and monthly repayment calculations.
- **Workbook Analysis** – Explanations of your design, formula, and print setup choices.

Additional Requirements

- Follow the "Excel Good Practice Guidelines" PDF (located in the Project Instructions module).
- Add a description of your chosen destination with a brief summary of the trip, including at least one relevant image.
- Format and style the workbook for clarity and visual appeal.

Worksheet 1: Trip Expenses

Track all anticipated trip costs and calculate totals for easy adjustment if trip details change. Set this up using formulas so you can easily change the values. Use actual pricing from sources, such as a hotel website or airfare aggregator.

Suggested Expense Categories:

- Airfare (round-trip costs per traveler)
- Car Rental (cost per day and total rental duration)
- Lodging (hotel, Airbnb, or other accommodations)
- Food (3 meals per day for each traveler)
- Souvenirs (budget for gifts)
- Excursions (specific activities or tours at your destination)



Required Fields for Each Expense:

- **Description** – Brief name of each expense.
- **Quantity** – Number of units (e.g., days, meals).
- **Unit Cost** – Cost per item or per day.
- **Total Cost** – Calculated cost for each expense.
- **% of Total Trip Costs** – Expense as a percentage of the total trip cost.
- **URL** – Link to sources (optional).

Additional Calculations:
Incorporate these calculations to further deepen your analysis.

- Total cost of the trip
- Average cost of all the expenses
- Number of expenses
- Consider using the functions from Chapters 2 and 3; Sum, Average, Count, CountA, etc.

Worksheet 2 – Loan Analysis

Decide if you want to borrow the maximum of $5,000 or less, depending on your personal savings and estimated costs.

Required Fields:

- **Estimated Trip Cost** – Use a cell reference linking from the Trip Expenses worksheet.
- **Loan Amount** – Maximum of $5,000.
- **Monthly Payment** – Calculated using the PMT function.
- **Total Repayment Amount** – Sum of all payments over the loan term.
- **Cost Difference** – Difference between borrowed and total repayment amount.
- **Decision IF Function** – Add a formula that results in either "Yes" or "No" based on your criteria (e.g., monthly payment or overall cost difference).

Decision Reflection
Write a paragraph summarizing your decision on whether to borrow for the trip. Discuss any other factors (financial or personal) influencing your choice.

Worksheet 3 – Workbook Analysis

Worksheet Structure: Describe why you set up the worksheets the way you did, including your column choices and formulas.

Formatting Analysis – Describe your choices behind your design elements like color schemes and number formats.

Print Setup Analysis – what print setup options did you use? Why did you use them?